

Morning Coffee as a Daily Ritual: A Mixed-Methods Study

Thesis proposal, Department of Sociology

1. Introduction

Coffee is part of the morning for most adults. Little is known about what the first cup does beyond caffeine, or why people try to drink less.

2. Aim of the study

The aim of this study is to understand what the morning coffee ritual means to regular drinkers and what leads them to cut down or change where they buy coffee.

3. Research questions

RQ1: What role does the morning coffee ritual play in people's day?

RQ2: Why do people try to cut down, and what helps them stick to it?

RQ3: How much does price shape where and how often people buy coffee?

4. Hypotheses

H1: For regular drinkers, the pause matters more than the caffeine.

H2: Sleep and health worries are the main reason people cut down.

We assume that café price rises push people to brew at home.

5. Method

We will survey around 50 coffee drinkers and interview five regulars of a local café. Participants are recruited through the café and social media.